

1648

THE FRONDE

During Louis XIV's childhood, his mother Anne of Austria ruled France with her chief minister, Cardinal Mazarin. In a revolt known as the Fronde, the government was challenged by the law courts and by the nobility, both claiming to defend traditional freedoms. After a five-year struggle, Mazarin restored absolute royal authority.



▷ Cardinal Mazarin



1648

PEACE OF WESTPHALIA

Treaties signed in the Westphalian cities of Osnabrück and Münster in 1648 ended both the Thirty Years' War between Catholics and Protestants and the Eighty Years' War between the Dutch and Spanish. A landmark in European international relations, the settlement allowed German states to determine their own policies on religion and ratified the full independence of the Netherlands and Switzerland.

< Signing of the Treaty of Münster

1649 Persian Shah Abbas II captures Kandahar from the Mughal Empire

1649 Cromwell's English Parliamentary forces slaughter Irish Catholics at Drogheda during their conquest of Ireland

1649

“We will cut off his head with the crown upon it.”

OLIVER CROMWELL DURING THE TRIAL OF CHARLES I, DECEMBER 1648

